

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 5
 ♥ J 10 9 8
 ♦ 9 6 4
 ♣ 10 3

♠ 9 6 2

♥ Q 5

♦ Q 10 5

♣ A Q 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 3

♥ K 6 4 3

♦ K 7 3 2

♣ 5 2

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 7 2

♦ A J 8

♣ K J 8 6

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

 3NT by South
 Or not.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥J. You try dummy's ♥Q but East plays the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=5 Total = 7

Things do not look good. You have only one ♥ stopper, the ♠ suit is wide open, and you have to have the ♦ finesse to get the two extra winners you need.

First problem: Do you hold up the ♥A or not?

No, don't hold up. If you do they might take 4 ♠ tricks immediately, then go back to ♥s. Since your only hope of making this contract is the ♦ finesse you should grab the ♥A, play 5 rounds of ♣s then finesse for the ♦K.

Remember: don't hold up when it gives the defenders a good opportunity to switch.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ K J 9 6 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4
♥ 8 5
♦ K J 10 3
♣ 7 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 2
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 9 7
♣ A 10 8 3

♠ A K 5
♥ A 7 2
♦ A Q 6 5
♣ K J 6

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT
All Pass

3NT by South
tricks, then the ♠ A, ♠ Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when East plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

This is not a guess. If West has the ♣ A he will get the lead and when he does he will set you with 2 more ♥ tricks. So you assume that East has the ♣ A and play your ♣ K.

This is a lesson about holding up, and if you had not held up twice in ♥s you would certainly have gone down.

But it's not enough to just be smart enough to hold up, you must also be able to figure out how to make the best plays later as well.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥ 6. East plays the ♥ Q.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=0 Total = 8

Needing only one more winner you decide to hold up on the first ♥ and also the ♥ continuation. You take your ♥ A on the third round, West having used the ♥ 3 to drive out your ♥ A.

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠ A, ♠ Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when East plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

[showcards N:S7,C7,C5,C4 S:SK,CK,CJ,C6]

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦